Unit 10: The Punishment of Shahpesh, the Persian, on Khipil, the Builder

Board-style MCQs with answer key at the end

MCQs — Unit 10: The Punishment of Shahpesh, the Persian, on Khipil, the Builder

Total: 59 MCQs. Answer key is given at the end.

1. The author of the story is:

- a) Sean O'Casey
- b) George Meredith
- c) William Blake
- d) Robert Hayden

2. George Meredith (1828–1909) was an:

- a) American poet
- b) English novelist and poet
- c) French writer
- d) Irish playwright

3. The story is set in:

- a) Arabia
- b) Persia
- c) India
- d) Egypt

4. Shahpesh commanded the building of:

- a) a mosque
- b) a palace
- c) a fort
- d) a bridge

5. The work lingered from the first year of the reign to:

- a) the second year
- b) the fourth year
- c) the tenth year
- d) the twentieth year

6. When the King inspected the palace, Khipil was:

- a) working hard

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- b) reciting adventures to idle workers
- c) sleeping
- d) absent

7. The King told a story about a farm servant who:

- a) sowed seeds well
- b) neglected sowing but sang of his soil at harvest
- c) built a palace
- d) became a king

8. Khipil conducted the King among:

- a) finished halls
- b) unfinished saloons and roofless rooms
- c) gardens
- d) markets

9. The King praised Khipil's:

- a) laziness
- b) craft, labour, speed, and assiduity
- c) silence
- d) absence

10. On the terrace, Khipil stopped because of:

- a) a wall
- b) a wide gap with deep water below
- c) a door
- d) a guard

11. Khipil could not swim, so he:

- a) jumped easily
- b) fell into the water
- c) flew over
- d) swam across

12. The King called the gap:

- a) a well
- b) an apt contrivance for a bath
- c) a river
- d) a trap

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13. The marble chair of state was:

- a) finished
- b) not yet executed
- c) broken
- d) golden

14. The King ordered Khipil to remain seated until:

- a) evening
- b) noon
- c) midnight
- d) morning

15. If Khipil moved, he would be transfixed with:

- a) ten arrows
- b) twenty-five arrows
- c) fifty arrows
- d) five arrows

16. The people laughed at Khipil because he was:

- a) singing
- b) sitting on nothing
- c) dancing
- d) eating

17. The King's gardens were full of:

- a) flowers
- b) weeds and nettles
- c) roses
- d) trees

18. The King ordered Khipil to pluck a handful of:

- a) flowers
- b) nettles
- c) roses
- d) leaves

19. The nosegay was sent to:

- a) the King's wife
- b) Khipil's mistress
- c) the queen

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- d) the court

20. The mistress received Khipil:

- a) with joy
- b) with wrath
- c) with gifts
- d) with silence

21. Khipil gasped without water for:

- a) one day
- b) three days and three nights
- c) seven days
- d) ten days

22. Khipil stood with stretched arms for:

- a) three days
- b) seven days and seven nights
- c) one night
- d) two days

23. In each hand Khipil held:

- a) a flower
- b) a pomegranate
- c) a stone
- d) a sword

24. The central message of the story is:

- a) talk is better than work
- b) words without deeds are worthless
- c) kings are cruel
- d) builders are lazy

25. The story is a satire on:

- a) war
- b) valuing words over deeds
- c) trade
- d) travel

26. Shahpesh punished Khipil through:

- a) execution
- b) irony and mock-honour

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- c) exile
- d) imprisonment

27. The poet's advice at the end is:

- a) 'Talk more'
- b) 'Leave to bloom the flower of things, and dig among the roots'
- c) 'Sleep more'
- d) 'Travel more'

28. 'Loquacious' means:

- a) silent
- b) talking a lot
- c) angry
- d) lazy

29. 'Mason' means:

- a) a king
- b) a person who builds with stone
- c) a poet
- d) a soldier

30. 'Nosegay' means:

- a) a crown
- b) a small bunch of flowers
- c) a necklace
- d) a ring

31. 'Transfix' means:

- a) to free
- b) to make unable to move with fear
- c) to praise
- d) to reward

32. 'Wrath' means:

- a) joy
- b) extreme anger
- c) peace
- d) sorrow

33. 'Humiliate' means:

- a) to honour

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- b) to make ashamed or foolish
- c) to praise
- d) to help

34. 'Magnanimity' means:

- a) anger
- b) generosity and forgiveness
- c) pride
- d) wealth

35. 'Gabble' means:

- a) silence
- b) fast, unclear talk
- c) singing
- d) writing

36. 'Anecdote' means:

- a) a long novel
- b) a short interesting story
- c) a poem
- d) a letter

37. 'Assiduity' means:

- a) laziness
- b) great care and perseverance
- c) anger
- d) speed

38. 'Contrived' means:

- a) natural
- b) planned in advance and not natural
- c) accidental
- d) simple

39. 'Dominate' means:

- a) to serve
- b) to have control or power over
- c) to obey
- d) to flee

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40. The synonym of 'wrath' is:

- a) joy
- b) anger
- c) peace
- d) mercy

41. The antonym of 'humiliate' is:

- a) shame
- b) honour
- c) insult
- d) disgrace

42. Choose the correct form: 'Khipil faced the king's ___ after neglecting the palace.'

- a) wrath
- b) wrathful
- c) wrathfully
- d) wrathless

43. Choose the correct form: 'Shahpesh used his authority to ___ Khipil.'

- a) humiliate
- b) humiliation
- c) humiliating
- d) humiliated

44. Choose the correct modal: 'Khipil ___ have been more careful in his work.'

- a) must
- b) might
- c) should
- d) could

45. Choose the correct modal: 'Shahpesh ___ be testing Khipil's loyalty.'

- a) must
- b) might
- c) should
- d) will

46. 'Trembling with fear, Khipil stepped forward' — 'Trembling' is a:

- a) gerund
- b) present participle

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- c) past participle
- d) infinitive

47. 'Building the palace was a challenging task' — 'Building' is a:

- a) gerund
- b) present participle
- c) past participle
- d) adjective

48. 'Shahpesh enjoyed watching Khipil's struggle' — 'watching' is a:

- a) gerund
- b) present participle
- c) infinitive
- d) noun

49. Choose the correct conditional: 'If Khipil finishes the palace on time, the King ___ him.'

- a) will reward
- b) would reward
- c) rewards
- d) rewarded

50. Choose the correct conditional: 'If Khipil were a loyal builder, he ___ the palace.'

- a) will complete
- b) would have completed
- c) completes
- d) completed

51. 'The punishment was harsh, humiliating, and made Khipil fearful' shows:

- a) parallel structure
- b) no structure
- c) repetition
- d) rhyme

52. 'Khipil knew one thing: he could not escape the king's wrath' uses a:

- a) comma
- b) colon
- c) semicolon
- d) dash

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53. 'The punishment was cruel; it was a lesson for everyone' uses a:

- a) comma
- b) colon
- c) semicolon
- d) full stop

54. The story's style uses:

- a) simple modern English
- b) elevated, poetic language
- c) slang
- d) scientific terms

55. The story draws on the tradition of:

- a) Western novels
- b) Middle Eastern moral storytelling
- c) Greek drama
- d) Roman history

56. After Khipil's punishment, business currents that had become stagnant pools:

- a) dried up
- b) began to flow again
- c) flooded
- d) froze

57. 'The tongue a constructor rather than a commentator' means people fancied:

- a) talking was the same as doing work
- b) writing was important
- c) silence was best
- d) building was easy

58. Khipil's character at the end is:

- a) defiant
- b) resigned and broken
- c) proud
- d) happy

59. The unfinished palace symbolises:

- a) the King's wealth
- b) Khipil's incomplete work and empty talk

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- c) the court's power
- d) the people's joy

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Answer Key

No.	Correct Answer
1	b) George Meredith
2	b) English novelist and poet
3	b) Persia
4	b) a palace
5	b) the fourth year
6	b) reciting adventures to idle workers
7	b) neglected sowing but sang of his soil at harvest
8	b) unfinished saloons and roofless rooms
9	b) craft, labour, speed, and assiduity
10	b) a wide gap with deep water below
11	b) fell into the water
12	b) an apt contrivance for a bath
13	b) not yet executed
14	b) noon
15	b) twenty-five arrows
16	b) sitting on nothing
17	b) weeds and nettles
18	b) nettles
19	b) Khipil's mistress
20	b) with wrath
21	b) three days and three nights
22	b) seven days and seven nights
23	b) a pomegranate
24	b) words without deeds are worthless
25	b) valuing words over deeds
26	b) irony and mock-honour
27	b) 'Leave to bloom the flower of things, and dig among the roots'
28	b) talking a lot
29	b) a person who builds with stone
30	b) a small bunch of flowers

No.	Correct Answer
31	b) to make unable to move with fear
32	b) extreme anger
33	b) to make ashamed or foolish
34	b) generosity and forgiveness
35	b) fast, unclear talk
36	b) a short interesting story
37	b) great care and perseverance
38	b) planned in advance and not natural
39	b) to have control or power over
40	b) anger
41	b) honour
42	a) wrath
43	a) humiliate
44	c) should
45	b) might
46	b) present participle
47	a) gerund
48	a) gerund
49	a) will reward
50	b) would have completed
51	a) parallel structure
52	b) colon
53	c) semicolon
54	b) elevated, poetic language
55	b) Middle Eastern moral storytelling
56	b) began to flow again
57	a) talking was the same as doing work
58	b) resigned and broken
59	b) Khipil's incomplete work and empty talk